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Geotagging

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Geotagging

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Tagging is one of the defining characteristics of Web 2.0 services and platforms. Tagging techniques allow users to collectively annotate, classify, and categorize content. Social tagging systems are a mix of two standards: one based on user actions, and another based on the system architecture that defines the rules and relationships between users and resource tags. Geotagging is a feature that is presented individually to users. The users can share locations and add geolocated data to content. Adding geographical identification metadata to an information resource attaches value to the content by making it more searchable.

Geotagging is the process of adding metadata with geographical identification to content. It is also defined as a form of geospatial metadata. The geotagging process derived from global position systems (GPS), which are based on a latitude and longitude coordinates model. Thus, the positions assumed by geotagging-enabled information services stem from this pattern.

Geotagging enables the spatial indexing of content. Therefore, it is a process of recognized geographic locations that enhances the development of geographical databases, geo-referenced Web resources, and geo-referenced multimedia content. Consequently, geotagging is a practice that completely modifies how the user interacts with content and other users in digital space. Systems with geotagging features usually add to media content latitude and longitude coordinates, distance, and place names. The data added consists of textual and visual features.

Geotagging standards in electronic file formats are embedded in the information in metadata. However, for each type of media, there are different protocols to attach geospatial information because geotag information can be read by several media systems. The main options of geotagging systems are the capture of GPS information at the time of publication or local position added by the user. Location-based services have different approaches to privacy, but most present default settings.

There are no industry standards. However, there are a variety of techniques implemented by diverse services with different purposes including to (1) propagate to friends a specific location; (2) suggest commercial and cultural information based on local position; (3) locate discount coupons for stores in the user's geographical area; (4)

aggregate data for a location; and (5) provide real-time, location-based searches. There are also several other geotagging applications in different contexts and business, such as event or object recognition, geolocation, media visualization, services and products recommendations, social networking, and mapping.

The adoption of geospatial features allows tracking content or users by associating it with GPS. The presence of geographically relevant metadata can help users to find a variety of location-specific information, which generates geoawareness across the Web repository and within computer-mediated communication. Geotagging-enabled information services can be used to find location-based resources on news Web sites, multimedia content, and other platforms. Social media platforms often present content relevant to a given location.

Geotagging systems have complex dynamics to present content-derived location information. Proximity and sibling features are the most common, and are used to present places based on geographic distance and similar places and points of interest that share a parent in a geographic hierarchy.

There are several social media platforms with tag-based systems, such as Flickr and Facebook, which enable content to be found through a location search. These platforms allow users to add metadata to an information resource in an automatic or manual procedure.

Content indexation through geographic components emphasizes the location argument. The variety of geo-enabled features allows location-based, personalized information services targeting regional publics. Mobile applications and [p. 575 ↓] social platforms can benefit from the use of geographical information, which is based on a GPS and Wi-Fi triangulation. Several online services collect, provide, and analyze geo-information as a business. Geo-information is an important value for corporations, and it can be a market opportunity for business, for example, the social platform Foursquare. The business model of various mobile applications and Internet services is based on geotagging. Such features have also been the basis of the evolution of communication and interaction in the context of the social Web.

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The practice of geotagging is a technique of managing information on the social Web and an example of collective intelligence that provides insight into human social structures. Technological innovation in recent years and the proliferation of the Internet, GPS devices, smartphones, and tablets suggest that the availability of geotagged content will continue to expand.

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See Also:

- [Data Mining](#)
- [Folksonomy](#)
- [Foursquare](#)
- [Geo-Locational Enabling](#)

Further Readings

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